of testimony in Indian philosophy. Because orthodox philosophical literature of India accepts the word of the Vedas as true and because it accepts testimony, i.e., the word of a reliable person, as an independent source of knowledge different from perception and inference, it is popularly believed that Indian philosophy accepts authority as such as true and dispenses with proof. This, however, is not the case, and we often talk at cross purposes because we do not mean the same thing by authority. Let us see first what is *not* the place of authority in Indian philosophy.

First, testimony is only a *source* of knowledge and is not, as such, to be believed or regarded as true. If it were, there would be no such thing as belief in a particular testimony (say, of the Vedas) and not in authority in general. Those who quote the words of the Vedas as authority do not accept the words of their opponents as authority. Testimony, therefore, like other valid sources of knowledge, is only the *psychological cause* of knowledge and not the *logical ground* of its truth, which is to be determined on other grounds.

Second, testimony does not annul or replace other sources of knowledge, like perception and inference. No one engaged in philosophical activity maintains that it is not necessary to perceive or reason for oneself in view of the fact that some authority is there already to give us all knowledge. This would negate the rational activity itself. Anyone acquainted with philosophical and speculative activity in India would at once see that just the reverse is the case. Actually, the entire literature of the six orthodox systems of Indian philosophy, comprising the Nyāya theory of objects of knowledge and fallacies, the Vaiśeṣika theory of atoms and numbers, the Sāṁkhya theory of the twenty-four principles, the Yoga psychology of the control of the fluctuations of mind, the Mīmāṁsā theory of the self-illuminacy and self-validity of knowledge, and the different varieties of Vedānta, is all spun out of the speculations of the minds of the different thinkers, and hardly anything more than a few suggestions, concepts, and phrases of these later developments can be made to derive from the *śrutis* (the accepted authority of the Vedas).

What, therefore, is the role of testimony in these speculations? And what constitutes the logical ground of its truth? Testimony is *one of the traditionally admitted sources of knowledge.* It is recognized that verbal or written statements of reliable persons reveal as much of the knowledge of facts to another person as his own perceptions and reasoning do. It is through testimony that a child gets his knowledge from parents or teachers, and adults know of